

are leveraging the *edx.org* platform today, or creating their own customised versions, based on their learning needs.

URL: <https://open.edx.org/>

Moodle

This is one of the oldest frameworks built for a virtual learning environment and its initial release was in 2002. The objective of Moodle is to create online courses for different modes of learning, combined with self-paced learning. Today, it has more than 90 million users and major releases occur twice a year. It is based on PHP, JavaScript and CSS. It is highly extensible due to its modular nature and the plugins. It supports activities, resources, enrolment, authentication and other components of a typical LMS through plugins. There have been many changes in Moodle over the past 17 years. The latest version is Moodle 3.8.

URL: <https://moodle.org/>

Code collaboration tools

GitLab

Git is a popular source code management (SCM) protocol and supports distributed version control systems (VCS). Most open source projects are currently on Git hosting services like GitHub and others. To leverage the advantages of SCM, we can also host internal Git repos. GitLab is a good option for this with its complete continuous integration (CI) and continuous deployment/delivery (CD) tool chain. The community edition is free and easy to install in any on-premise server or available cloud service. When delivering educational content, GitLab can offer examples with wikis, along with lab manuals documented with version tracking (branches). It can also create groups for collaborative team work and submissions. CI/CD workflows can be integrated for build checks, issue trackers, to check code quality parameters and to present different dashboards.

URL: <https://docs.gitlab.com/>

Jenkins

This is a leading automation server with a rich set of plugins for engineering programming languages like C, C++, Java and Python. For the purpose of education content delivery, CI/CD pipelines can be set up to perform particular tasks, which include platform-specific builds, various code quality checks like static analysis, heap error detection, code complexity and standard compliance. xUnit frameworks can be integrated to perform unit and integration testing, and coverage. Also, rich dashboards and trending charts are supported to visualise the changes, based on the build.

URL: <https://jenkins.io/>

Submission tracking and assessment engines

Submitty

This is an open source programming assignment-submission system developed for programming courses in engineering institutes. Submitted code can be evaluated manually as per predefined rubrics or automatically against test metrics. It comes with a rich set of plugins for various checks on programming assignments like compilation, execution, coding style, static analysis, and memory leak detection for automated assessments. Scores can be configured for each of the desired parameters. We can check the functionality of the code with the help of the available xUnit framework. The evaluation can also be configured as a combined score in dual mode, i.e., some parameters get checked automatically and some manually. This framework helps the engineering faculty to set up formal assessments and programming challenges.

URL: <https://submitty.org/>

Codeboard.io

This is a Web based IDE for teaching programming modules. Examples can be created for sharing with students,

or one can create blank/partial code and encourage students to submit the completed solutions. Examples in popular languages like C, C++ (up to C++14 std), Java and Python (with support for unit testing in the latter two) can be created. Codeboard.io can be hosted internally through Docker images. It can integrate with popular LMSs in engineering education through LTI plugins.

URL: <https://codeboard.io/>

TAO Testing

TAO is a next-generation open source assessment framework, with support for single sign-on and LTI. It can easily integrate assessments with popular LMSs. It is Question and Test Interoperability (QTI) compliant and has a great degree of interoperability with other LMS solutions. It offers a strong role based access matrix to define privileges for various roles like admin, test author, invigilator, student, etc, for hosting and managing the assessments, which can be objective questions using multiple choice or 'mix and match' questions.

URL: <https://www.taotesting.com/>

MCU simulation tools

Qemu

This is an open source emulator with support for various architecture families. It allows full system emulation with GUI and network support. The GNU MCU Eclipse project comes with a customised version of Qemu, which can emulate additional MCU targets like the STM32 family with Eclipse plugins for a complete development cycle. From mid-2019 onwards, these custom Qemu binaries have been part of the xPack project. Do refer to a previous article in OSFY for more details on the GNU MCU Eclipse project (<https://opensourceforu.com/2017/12/developing-arm-targets-using-gnu-mcu-eclipse/>).

URL: <https://xpack.github.io/qemu-arm/>